Isaac Sherwood

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Education

University of Maryland (UMD) — College Park, MD
B.S. Physics — *Graduation May 2027*

Publications

Optical observation of interlayer spin correlation — *September 2026*
A. Park, P. Upadhyay, A. Grankin, E. Viñas Boström, M. Ghafariasl, H. Alnatah, M. Mohammadi-Arzanagh, G. Nambiar, B. Gao, A. Alvandi, S. Rajmano Madhan Kumar, G. Alshalan, **I. Sherwood**, M. Jalali Mehrabad, Y. Zhou, A. Ramanathan, X. Roy, A. Rubio, M. Hafezi
Under review [arXiv:2609.38825]

Presentations

Metamaterial engineering of thin film superconductors — *October 2026*
Oral presentation, UMD Physics Undergraduate Committee Colloquium, College Park, MD

Metamaterial Engineering of Quantum Devices — *July 2026*
M. Hafezi, V. Galitski, A. Yacoby, A. Park, **I. Sherwood**
Oral presentation, DARPA SynQuaNon Program Review Meeting, Alexandria, VA

Professional Experience

Joint Quantum Institute, Dept. of Physics, UMD
Research Assistant — *September 2025–Present*

- Investigating the effects of nanopatterning on the behavior of superconducting materials through fabrication and low temperature measurements in Prof. Mohammad Hafezi's lab.
- Fabricating plasmonic metasurfaces from silver to investigate their interaction with excitons in transition metal dichalcogenides.
- Fabricated devices for use in measurements of interlayer spin correlations in the van der Waals antiferromagnet CrSBr.
- Fabrication and characterization of nanoscale devices using electron beam lithography, scanning electron microscopy, reactive ion etching, and low temperature measurements.

Quantum Materials Center, Dept. of Materials Science and Engineering, UMD
Research Assistant — *August 2024–September 2026*

- Experimental research in superconductors and topological materials, focusing on device fabrication and quantum transport phenomena, in Prof. Ichiro Takeuchi's lab.

- Fabricated indium and bismuth palladium spin injection devices using photolithography, ion beam etching, and other fabrication techniques; performed low temperature measurements.

Summer Student Theoretical Physics Research Session Dept. of Physics,
Undergraduate Researcher *June 2026–Present*

- Studying theoretical physics with a focus on supersymmetric theories and the underlying mathematical structures, including Lie groups and algebras, Clifford algebras, and differential geometry, mentored by Prof. Sylvester James Gates Jr.
- Researching the dimensional reduction of four-dimensional N = 1 supersymmetric algebras and their representations in three-dimensional space time.

Blue Wave Semiconductors, Inc.
Technical Intern *Jun 2023–Jan 2024*
High School Apprentice *Oct 2022–Jun 2023*

- Led research in developing new techniques for fusion and eutectic bonding of semiconductor and insulating materials.
- Assisted in construction, operation, and maintenance of ultra-high vacuum and thin film deposition systems for research and industrial fabrication including thermal evaporators, pulsed laser deposition, sputtering, and chemical vapor deposition systems.
- Worked on a team to write project proposals and conduct background research for potential research projects and business partnerships.

Department of Physics Summer Programs, UMD
Summer Camp Counselor *June 2026–July 2026*

- Summer camp counselor for The Amazing Science Discovery Camp and Advanced Physics Summer Program at UMD.
- Led group activities, presented demonstrations, taught lessons to students between the 3rd and 12th grades.

Department of Physics, UMD
Teaching Assistant for Modern Physics *January 2026–May 2026*
Teaching Assistant for Quantum Physics I *August 2026–Present*

- Teaching assistant for two upper-level degree requirements for physics majors covering early quantum mechanics, thermodynamics, special relativity (Modern Physics), as well as two state systems, bound and unbound particles, the harmonic oscillator, and the hydrogen atom (Quantum Physics I).
- Holding discussion sections and problem-solving sessions, proctoring exams, grading exams and homework assignments, answering student questions and providing academic support.

Society of Physics Students, UMD Chapter
Paid Physics Tutor *January 2025–Present*
Volunteer Physics Tutor *September 2024–December 2024*

- Paid tutor tutoring undergraduate physics and engineering majors in introductory mechanics, electricity and magnetism, and upper-level physics courses.

College of Information Science, UMD
Archival Research Secretary *February 2024–August 2024*

- Collaborated with members of the Piscataway Conoy Tribe and university archivists to locate culturally significant images, documents, and artifacts for use in an upcoming book and the tribe's ongoing education projects, ensuring proper copyright permissions.

Leadership and Volunteer Experience

Society of Physics Students, UMD Chapter
President *June 2026–Present*
Outreach Coordinator *June 2025–June 2026*
Member *September 2023–Present*

- Organized a public lecture series focused on ongoing physics research and career development featuring 10+ faculty speakers.
- Planned physics demonstration shows, recruitment events, fundraisers, weekly meetings, resume workshops, career development workshops, and social gatherings for undergraduate physics majors at UMD.
- Worked on an organizing committee to plan and run the 2025 Society of Physics Students Zone 4 Meeting, including student talks and presentations, a poster session, and lab tours.

Physics Department Outreach, UMD
Outreach Presenter *September 2024–Present*

- Planning and running outreach events at the UMD Physics Department for elementary, middle, and high schoolers, as well as the general public.
- Involved with over 20 outreach events, including Physics is Phun, Discovery Days, Maryland Day, local high school visits, and other educational science programs for the community.

QURISE Local Organizing Committee, Department of Physics, UMD
Conference Organizer *December 2025–January 2026*

- Planned and organized events and lab tours for 60+ attendees at a quantum research conference hosted at UMD.

Engineers Without Borders, UMD Chapter
Treasurer *May 2024–June 2025*
Structures Team Member *September 2023–June 2025*

- Managed all money and resources for the university-wide organization chapter.
- Designed and implemented sanitation and water facilities for St. Anne Grace School in Nakifuma, Uganda and a health clinic in Guatemala with a focus in structural design.

Technical Skills

Mathematics:

- Algebra: linear algebra; groups, rings, fields, Galois theory; Lie groups and Lie algebras
- Calculus; multivariable calculus, ordinary and partial differential equations
- Python programming

Nanofabrication and characterization:

- Electron-beam lithography, maskless photolithography
- Wet chemical etching, reactive ion etching, ion beam etching
- Scanning electron microscopy, atomic force microscopy, optical microscopy
- Low temperature superconductivity measurements

Thin film deposition and vacuum systems:

- Ultra-high vacuum system construction, repair, and maintenance
- Sputtering, thermal evaporation, electron beam evaporation
- Atomic layer deposition, chemical vapor deposition

Other Skills:

- Writing grant proposals, technical articles
- Typesetting in Latex
- CAD: Autodesk Fusion 360, AutoCAD, KLayout

Honors and Awards

- Sigma Pi Sigma inductee *April 2026*
- Dean's List *Fall 2025–Present*

Coursework

University of Maryland *September 2023–Present*

- **Physics Coursework**:
    - Quantum Physics I - II

    - Statistical Thermodynamics
    - Classical Mechanics (in progress)
    - Advanced Electrodynamics (in progress)
    - Making Physics Experiments (in progress)
    - Particle Astrophysics
    - Modern Physics
    - Intermediate Electricity and Magnetism
    - Python Programming
- **Mathematics Coursework**:
    - Introduction to Abstract Algebra (Group Theory)
    - Linear Algebra (Advanced)
    - Field Theory (Galois Theory)
    - Euclidean and Non-Euclidean Geometry
    - Introduction to Mathematical Proof
- **Other relevant coursework**:
    - Nuclear Reactor Design, Nuclear Reactor Systems and Safety
    - Technical Writing, Teaching STEM I, Teaching STEM II (in progress)

Rangjung Yeshe Institute, Kathmandu University *June 2025–August 2025*

- Buddhist Studies Summer Intensive Program: Formal study of Buddhist philosophy and history at Ka Nying Shedrub Ling Monastery with a focus on Tibetan Buddhism.